intervention, it looked upon the event with extreme disdain. The ensuing civil war in Afghanistan fundamentally altered the structural balance in Pakistan's favour. Afghanistan today is arguably among the weakest states in the world constituting a highly divided society susceptible to external interference. This makes India nervous that Afghan territory may be used for training militants to foment violence in Kashmir (and elsewhere), often leading policymakers in New Delhi to incorrectly blame Afghan groups for supporting anti-India militancy. It is in this context that India advocates a strong, stable, inclusive, and sovereign Afghanistan that is not dependent on Pakistan for its economic and political survival. Addressing, if not correcting, this structural imbalance between Afghanistan and Pakistan lies at the heart of India's current policy approach towards Kabul.

As this book shows, India's foreign policy is a dynamic process of constant interaction between the agent and the structure. The evolving global order and India's material and economic capacities set the structural confines within which foreign policy options are debated. Within these structural limits, Indian policymakers have the agency to choose between a conformist or revisionist policy approach. On issues such as nuclear power and climate change, India adopted a revisionist course that ended up changing the global nuclear order and climate change debates. Within South Asia, India prefers status quo in order to preserve its dominance (to be challenged by Pakistan). Though critical in influencing India's foreign policy, such structural factors do not adequately explain policy change. To understand why India choses a particular policy path in Afghanistan or other areas, there is a need to highlight the interplay between India's political objectives and the various policy beliefs held by different Indian policymakers. For example, India's rising economic and political power does not explain the numerous shifts in India's Afghanistan policy between 1979 and 2015.

Theoretical constructs such as the Advocacy Coalition Framework (ACF) help teasing out the complexity of India's foreign policy debates. It helps explaining the interplay between policy beliefs held by different Indian policymakers across bureaucratic and political lines, and changing regional and global geopolitical dynamics. All factions standing at odds with Pakistan and/or